

Paula Dastres Gallardo

dastresgalla@wisc.edu | pauladastresg.github.io

Research Interests

Labor Economics, Public Economics, Gender Inequality, Development Economics

Education

University of Wisconsin–Madison 2025–Present

PhD in Economics, expected 2031

University of Chicago, Harris School of Public Policy 2023–2024

Master of Arts with Certificate in Research Methods, with Honors

Relevant coursework: Game Theory; Applied Econometrics I–III; Advanced Microeconomics for Policy Analysis I–II; Experimental Economics; Behavioral Economics; Development Economics.

Universidad Adolfo Ibáñez, School of Government 2020–2021

Master's in Economics and Public Policy, ranked 1st

Relevant coursework: Impact Evaluation; Labor Economics; Economics of Education; Data Science; Cost–Benefit Analysis.

Universidad Adolfo Ibáñez 2015–2019

Bachelor's in Economics, ranked 3rd; Minor in Political Science

Research Experience

Research Assistant, Messages, Identity, and Inclusion in Education Lab 2024–2025

University of Chicago

Constructed, cleaned, and analyzed large scale datasets containing text and image information from children's textbooks and literature. Analyzed experimental data from Bangladesh for follow up research on child marriage, including the construction and analysis of skin tone measures from participant images.

Research Consultant 2023

TECHO Chile, Socio-Territorial Research Center

Conducted impact evaluations of three electrification projects implemented in informal housing settlements in Santiago, Chile, using a dataset I had previously helped design and construct.

Research Assistant, Alejandra Abufhele and Luis Herskovic 2023

Universidad Adolfo Ibáñez

Conducted the literature review and developed the conceptual framework for a research project on migration and educational outcomes.

Coordinator of Quantitative Research and Innovation 2022

TECHO Chile, Socio-Territorial Research Center

Participated in the full data collection process for impact evaluations of electrification projects in informal housing settlements, including sample size determination, sample construction, survey design and implementation, and data cleaning. Served as a spokesperson for the organization in press interviews on housing and public policy issues.

Research Intern 2021

Centro de Estudios Públicos (CEP)

Conducted descriptive data analysis and literature reviews for projects on mental health and public opinion. Contributed to the development and review of an interactive data visualization tool used to communicate survey results and inform public debate in Chile.

Research Assistant, Francisca Rengifo and Andrea Repetto 2021

Universidad Adolfo Ibáñez

Supported an interdisciplinary research project on social policies for families.

Research Assistant, Daniel Briebe 2020

Universidad Adolfo Ibáñez

Participated in the full process of scraping, cleaning, and constructing a comprehensive administrative dataset on public sector employment in Chile, later used across multiple research projects, including an analysis of the gender wage gap.

Research Assistant, Andrea Repetto 2019

Universidad Adolfo Ibáñez

Conducted a literature review for a research project on retirement and health savings decisions.

Skills

Programming: Advanced R and L^AT_EX; intermediate Stata; basic Python. **Languages:** Spanish (native), English (advanced), Italian (intermediate).

Selected Research

Working Paper

- “How Do We Teach Emotions? Representation in Children’s Textbooks and Literature,” with Anjali Adukia, Matthew Bonci, Emileigh Harrison, Jake Nicoll, and Teodora Szasz. University of Chicago.

Publications

- “The Migration Phenomenon in Informal Housing Settlements: Challenges for Urban Public Policies in Chile.” *Revista Planeo*, 51, 2023.
- “The Common Rationality of Liberalism and Science through the Feminist Lens,” with Cristóbal Bellolio. *Atenea*, 526, 111–134, 2022.
- “Towards a New Dawn: Trajectories of Exclusion of Women Living in Informal Housing Settlements,” with Florencia Vergara, Paz Zúñiga, and Pía Palacios, 2022.
- “The Growing Problem of Housing Affordability in Chile,” with Ray Anderson, 2022.
- “Quantitative Housing Deficit in Chile,” with Pía Palacios, 2022.

Selected Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, Principles of Microeconomics — University of Wisconsin–Madison	2025–2026
Teaching Assistant, Behavioral Science for Public Policy — University of Chicago	2025
Grader, Advanced Microeconomics for Policy Analysis II — University of Chicago	2025
Teaching Assistant, Gender and Policy — University of Chicago	2025
Lecturer, Microeconomics II — Universidad Adolfo Ibáñez	2022
Teaching Assistant, Labor Economics — Universidad Adolfo Ibáñez	2022

Selected Presentations

“Gender Gap in the Public Sector,” University of Talca	2020
“Gender Wage Gap in the Public Sector,” Universidad Adolfo Ibáñez	2020
“Substantially Similar: A Feminist Critique of Science and Liberalism,” Universidad Adolfo Ibáñez	2021